



Employee Handbook

Interactive Aptitude LLC

Welcome

Welcome to Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)!

Our employees use their creativity and talent to invent new solutions, meet new demands, and offer the most effective solutions in the industry. With your active involvement, added creativity, and support, IA will continue to achieve its goals. We sincerely hope you will take pride in being an important part of IA's success. Our success is a team effort. As you become familiar with our mission and culture, we hope you will take advantage of opportunities to enhance your career and further our goals.

Please take time to review the policies contained in this handbook. As a U.S. government defense contractor, IA may need to reference policies outside this handbook. If a policy is referenced, please note the policy document itself is authoritative over this handbook.

If you have questions, feel free to ask your supervisor or any leadership team member.

Sincerely,

James Vaccaro
CEO

Victor Bajenaru
CBDO

Christopher Wheeler
CTO

James Skinner
CFO

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1 Employment at Will

Employment at Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) is on an at-will basis unless otherwise stated in a written individual employment agreement signed by a company manager or officer, following approval of the company's management committee (board).

“At will” means that either the employee or the company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, for any reason, with or without notice.

Nothing in this employee handbook creates or is intended to create an employment agreement, express or implied. Nothing contained in this, or any other document provided to the employee is intended to be, nor should it be, construed as a contract that employment or any benefit will be continued for any period of time. In addition, no company representative is authorized to modify this policy for any employee or to enter into any agreement, oral or written, that changes the at-will relationship.

Any salary figures provided to an employee in annual or monthly terms are stated for the sake of convenience or to facilitate comparisons and are not intended to and do not create an employment contract for any specific period of time.

Nothing in this statement is intended to interfere with, restrain, or prevent concerted activity as protected by the National Labor Relations Act (NLRA). Such activity includes employee communications regarding wages, hours, or other terms or conditions of employment. IA employees have the right to engage in or refrain from such activities.

2 Equal Opportunity

2.1 Equal Opportunity

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) provides equal employment opportunities to all employees and applicants for employment without regard to race, color, creed, ancestry, national origin, citizenship, sex or gender (including pregnancy, childbirth, and pregnancy-related conditions), gender identity or expression (including transgender status), sexual orientation, marital status, religion, age, disability, genetic information, service in the military, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local laws and ordinances. Equal employment opportunity applies to all terms and conditions of employment, including hiring, placement, promotion, termination, layoff, recall, transfer, leave of absence, compensation, and training.

IA expressly prohibits any form of unlawful employee harassment or discrimination based on any of the characteristics mentioned above. Improper interference with the ability of other employees to perform their expected job duties is absolutely not tolerated.

IA will endeavor to make a reasonable accommodation of an otherwise qualified applicant or employee related to an individual's physical or mental disability, sincerely held religious beliefs and practices, and/or any other reason required by applicable law, unless doing so would impose an undue hardship upon IA's business operations.

Any employees with questions or concerns about equal employment opportunities in the workplace are encouraged to bring these issues to the attention of their supervisor or leadership team member. The company will not allow any form of retaliation against individuals who raise issues of equal employment opportunity. Employees who feel they have been subjected to any such retaliation should bring it to the attention of the HR manager.

Retaliation means adverse conduct taken because an individual reported an actual or a perceived violation of this policy, opposed practices prohibited by this policy, or participated in the reporting and investigation process described below. "Adverse conduct" includes but is not limited to:

- (1) Shunning and avoiding an individual who reports harassment, discrimination, or retaliation;
- (2) Express or implied threats or intimidation intended to prevent an individual from reporting harassment, discrimination, or retaliation; or
- (3) Denying employment benefits because an applicant or employee reported harassment, discrimination, or retaliation or participated in the reporting and investigation process.

Other examples of retaliation include firing, demotion, denial of promotion, unjustified negative evaluations, increased surveillance, harassment, and assault.

Complaints of discrimination should be filed according to the procedures described in the Harassment and Complaint Procedure.

2.2 Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and Reasonable Accommodation

Interactive Aptitude LLC is committed to the fair and equal employment of individuals with disabilities under the ADA. It is IA's policy to provide reasonable accommodation to qualified individuals with disabilities unless the accommodation would impose an undue hardship on the company. IA prohibits any harassment of, or discriminatory treatment of, employees or applicants based on a disability or because an employee has requested a reasonable accommodation.

In accordance with the ADA, reasonable accommodations will be provided to qualified individuals with disabilities to enable them to perform the essential functions of their jobs or to enjoy the equal benefits and privileges of employment. An employee or applicant with a disability may request an accommodation from the HR department and should specify what accommodation is needed to perform the job and submit supporting documentation explaining the basis for the requested accommodation, to the extent permitted and in accordance with applicable law. The company then will review and analyze the request, including engaging in an interactive process with the employee or applicant, to identify if such an accommodation can be made, or if any other possible accommodations are appropriate. If requested, the employee is responsible for providing medical documentation regarding the disability and possible accommodations. All information obtained concerning the medical condition or history of an applicant or employee will be treated as confidential information, maintained in separate medical files, and disclosed only as permitted by law.

It is the policy of IA to prohibit harassment or discrimination based on disability or because an employee has requested a reasonable accommodation. IA prohibits retaliation against employees for exercising their rights under the ADA or other applicable civil rights laws. Employees should use the procedures described in the Harassment and Complaint Procedure to report any harassment, discrimination, or retaliation they have experienced or witnessed.

2.3 Genetic Information Nondiscrimination (GINA)

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) complies with the Genetic Information Nondiscrimination Act of 2008 (GINA). IA prohibits discrimination against employees or applicants based on genetic information in all aspects of employment, including hiring, compensation, promotion, and termination.

IA will not request, require, or purchase genetic information about employees or their family members. Genetic information includes information about an individual's genetic tests, genetic tests of family members, the manifestation of a disease or disorder in family members (family medical history), and requests for or receipt of genetic services by an individual or family member.

If IA inadvertently receives genetic information, it will be treated as a confidential medical record, maintained in a separate file apart from the employee's personnel file, and will not be used for any employment decision. Disclosure of genetic information is restricted to the narrow circumstances permitted by law.

Employees who believe they have been subjected to discrimination or harassment based on genetic information should follow the complaint procedures described in Section 3 (Harassment and Complaint Procedure).

3 Harassment and Complaint Procedure

It is Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)'s policy to prohibit intentional and unintentional harassment of or against job applicants, contractors, interns, volunteers, or employees by another employee, supervisor, vendor, customer, or third party based on actual or perceived race, color, creed, religion, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, age, sex or gender (including pregnancy, childbirth, and pregnancy-related conditions), gender identity or expression (including transgender status), sexual orientation, marital status, military service and veteran status, physical or mental disability, genetic information, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local laws. Such conduct will not be tolerated by IA.

Furthermore, any retaliation against an individual who has complained about sexual or other harassment or retaliation against individuals for cooperating with an investigation of a harassment complaint is similarly unlawful and will not be tolerated. IA will take all reasonable steps necessary to prevent and eliminate unlawful harassment.

Definition of "unlawful harassment." "Unlawful harassment" is conduct that has the purpose or effect of creating an intimidating, a hostile, or an offensive work environment; has the purpose or effect of substantially and unreasonably interfering with an individual's work performance; or otherwise adversely affects an individual's employment opportunities because of the individual's membership in a protected class.

Unlawful harassment includes, but is not limited to, epithets; slurs; jokes; pranks; innuendo; comments; written or graphic material; stereotyping; or other threatening, hostile, or intimidating acts based on race, color, ancestry, national origin, gender, sex, sexual orientation, marital status, religion, age, disability, veteran status, or another characteristic protected by state or federal law.

Definition of "sexual harassment." While all forms of harassment are prohibited, special attention should be paid to sexual harassment. "Sexual harassment" can include all of the above actions, as well as other unwelcome conduct, and is generally defined under both state and federal law as unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature whereby:

- Submission to or rejection of such conduct is made either explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of any individual's employment or as a basis for employment decisions.
- Such conduct has the purpose or effect of unreasonably interfering with an individual's work performance or creating an intimidating, a hostile, or an offensive work environment.

Other sexually oriented conduct, whether intended or not, that is unwelcome and has the effect of creating a work environment that is hostile, offensive, intimidating, or humiliating to workers may also constitute sexual harassment.

While it is not possible to list all those additional circumstances that may constitute sexual harassment, the following are some examples of conduct that, if unwelcome, may constitute sexual harassment depending on the totality of the circumstances, including the severity of the conduct and its pervasiveness:

- Unwanted sexual advances, whether they involve physical touching or not;
- Sexual epithets; jokes; written or oral references to sexual conduct; gossip regarding one's sex life; comments about an individual's body; and comments about an individual's sexual activity, deficiencies, or prowess;
- Displaying sexually suggestive objects, pictures, or cartoons;
- Unwelcome leering, whistling, brushing up against the body, sexual gestures, or suggestive or insulting comments;
- Inquiries into one's sexual experiences; and
- Discussion of one's sexual activities.

All employees should take special note that, as stated above, retaliation against an individual who has complained about sexual or other harassment and retaliation against individuals for cooperating with an investigation of sexual or other harassment complaints violate IA's policy.

Complaint procedure. If an employee believes they have been subject to or have witnessed unlawful discrimination, including sexual or other forms of unlawful harassment, or other inappropriate conduct, they are requested and encouraged to make a complaint. They may complain directly to their immediate supervisor or department manager, or any other member of management with whom they feel comfortable bringing such a complaint. Similarly, if employees observe acts of discrimination toward or harassment of another employee, they are requested and encouraged to report this to one of the individuals listed above.

All complaints will be investigated promptly, and confidentiality will be protected to the extent possible. A timely resolution of each complaint should be reached and communicated to the parties involved.

If the investigation confirms conduct that violates this policy has occurred, Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) will take immediate, appropriate, corrective action, including discipline, up to and including immediate termination.

No reprisal, retaliation, or other adverse action will be taken against an employee for making a complaint or report of discrimination or harassment or for assisting in the investigation of any such complaint or report. Any suspected retaliation or intimidation should be reported immediately to one of the persons identified above.

3.1 Employee Complaint and Grievance Procedure

IA encourages employees to raise any workplace concern—not limited to harassment or discrimination—through a formal grievance process. This procedure supplements the harassment-specific complaint process described in Section 3 and is available for any work-related matter, including workplace conditions, interpersonal conflicts, policy disagreements, compensation concerns, safety issues, or any other matter affecting the employee's working environment.

How to file a grievance. Employees may submit a written or verbal complaint to their immediate supervisor, any member of the leadership team, or the HR department. Where the complaint involves the employee's direct supervisor, the employee may escalate directly to another leadership team member or HR.

Investigation. All complaints will be documented, acknowledged within five business days, and investigated promptly and impartially. The investigating party will interview relevant individuals, review available evidence,

and reach a determination. The employee will be informed of the outcome and any corrective actions taken, to the extent permitted by confidentiality obligations.

No retaliation. No employee will be subject to retaliation, intimidation, or adverse action for raising a good-faith complaint under this procedure. Any suspected retaliation should be reported immediately using the same channels described above.

3.2 Third parties (customers, clients, vendors, and other non-employees)

IA employees, supervisors, and managers are prohibited from engaging in discrimination, harassment (including sexual harassment), or retaliatory conduct toward any non-employee in the course of IA business — whether at IA's office, on a customer or government site, at a vendor's facility, at a conference or industry event, or through electronic communications. A violation of this expectation will be treated the same as harassment of a coworker and may result in corrective action up to and including termination, regardless of the third party's seniority, contract value, or relationship to IA.

4 Conflicts of Interest and Confidentiality

4.1 Conflicts of Interest

Interactive Aptitude LLC expects all employees to conduct themselves and company business in a manner that reflects the highest standards of ethical conduct and in accordance with all federal, state, and local laws and regulations. This includes avoiding real and potential conflicts of interests.

Exactly what constitutes a conflict of interest, or an unethical business practice is both a moral and a legal question. IA recognizes and respects the individual employee's right to engage in activities outside of employment that are private in nature and do not in any way conflict with or reflect poorly on the company.

It is not possible to define all the circumstances and relationships that might create a conflict of interest. If a situation arises in which there is a potential conflict of interest, the employee should discuss this with a manager for advice and guidance on how to proceed. The list below suggests some of the types of activities that indicate improper behavior, unacceptable personal integrity, or unacceptable ethics:

1. Simultaneous employment by another firm that is a competitor of or supplier to IA;
2. Carrying on company business with a firm in which the employee, or a close relative of the employee, has a substantial ownership or interest;
3. Holding a substantial interest in, or participating in the management of, a firm to which the company makes sales or from which it makes purchases;
4. Borrowing money from customers or firms, other than recognized loan institutions, from which our company buys services, materials, equipment, or supplies;
5. Accepting substantial gifts or excessive entertainment from an outside organization or agency;
6. Speculating or dealing in materials, equipment, supplies, services, or property purchased by the company;
7. Participating in civic or professional organization activities in a manner that divulges confidential company information;
8. Misusing privileged information or revealing confidential data to outsiders;

9. Using one's position in the company or knowledge of its affairs for personal gains; and
10. Engaging in practices or procedures that violate antitrust laws, commercial bribery laws, copyright laws, discrimination laws, campaign contribution laws, or other laws regulating the conduct of company business.

4.2 Confidential Information

The protection of confidential business information and trade secrets is vital to the interests and success of Interactive Aptitude LLC. Confidential information is any and all information disclosed to or known by employees because of employment with the company that is not generally known to people outside the company about its business.

An employee who improperly uses or discloses trade secrets or confidential business information will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment and legal action, even if the employee does not actually benefit from the disclosed information.

All inquiries from the media must be referred to a leadership team member. This provision is not intended to, and should not be interpreted to, prohibit employees from discussing wages and other terms and conditions of employment if they so choose.

DTSA notice. Under the federal Defend Trade Secrets Act (18 U.S.C. § 1833(b)), an individual is not criminally or civilly liable for disclosing a trade secret (i) in confidence to a federal, state, or local government official, or to an attorney, solely to report or investigate a suspected violation of law, or (ii) in a sealed filing in a lawsuit or other proceeding. An individual who files a lawsuit alleging retaliation for reporting a suspected violation of law may also disclose a trade secret to their attorney and use it in the court proceeding, if filed under seal.

5 Employment Relationship

5.1 Employee Privacy

It is Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)'s goal to respect the individual privacy of its employees and at the same time maintain a safe and secure workplace. When issues of safety and security arise, employees may be requested to cooperate with an investigation. The investigation may include the following procedures to safeguard the company and its employees: searches of personal belongings, searches of work areas, searches of private vehicles on company premises, medical examinations, and the like. Failure to cooperate with an investigation is grounds for termination. Providing false information during any investigation may lead to discipline, including termination.

Employees are expected to make use of company facilities only for the business purposes of the company. Accordingly, materials that appear on company hardware or networks are presumed to be for business purposes, and all such materials are subject to review by the company at any time without notice to the employees. Employees do not have to have any expectation of privacy with respect to any material on company property. IA regularly monitors its communications systems and networks as allowed by law. Monitored activity may include voice, e-mail, and text communications, as well as Internet search and browsing history.

5.2 Privacy—Social Security Numbers

Policy and Procedure Regarding Use and Disclosure of Social Security Numbers

Purpose. This policy and procedure explain Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)'s general standards and practices for how Social Security numbers are gathered, stored, disclosed, and ultimately disposed of.

Policy. It is IA's policy that Social Security numbers obtained from employees, vendors, contractors, customers, or others are confidential information. Social Security numbers will be obtained, retained, used, and disposed of only for legitimate business reasons and in accordance with the law and this policy.

Procedure. Documents or other records containing employee Social Security numbers generally will be requested, obtained, or created only for legitimate business reasons consistent with this policy. For example, Social Security numbers may be requested from employees for tax reporting purposes (i.e., Internal Revenue Service (IRS) Form W-4), for new hire reporting, or for purposes of enrollment in the company's employee benefit plans.

Retention and access to Social Security numbers. All records containing Social Security numbers (whether partial or complete) will be maintained in secure, confidential files with limited access.

Unauthorized use/disclosure of Social Security numbers. Any employee who obtains, uses, or discloses Social Security numbers for unauthorized purposes or contrary to the requirements of this policy and procedure may be disciplined, up to and including discharge. The company will cooperate with government investigations of any person alleged to have obtained, used, or disclosed Social Security numbers for unlawful purposes.

5.3 Employment Classification

In order to determine eligibility for benefits and overtime status and to ensure compliance with federal and state laws and regulations, Interactive Aptitude LLC classifies its employees as shown below. IA may review or change employee classifications at any time.

Exempt. Exempt employees are typically paid on a salary basis and are not eligible to receive overtime pay.

Nonexempt. Nonexempt employees are paid on an hourly basis and are eligible to receive overtime pay for overtime hours worked.

Regular, full-time. Employees who are not in a temporary status and work a minimum of 30 hours weekly and maintain continuous employment status. Generally, these employees are eligible for the full-time benefits package and are subject to the terms, conditions, and limitations of each benefits program.

Regular, part-time. Employees who are not in a temporary status and who are regularly scheduled to work less than 30 hours weekly but at least 20 hours weekly and who maintain continuous employment status. Part-time employees are eligible for some of the benefits offered by the company and are subject to the terms, conditions, and limitations of each benefits program.

Temporary, full-time. Employees who are hired as interim replacements to temporarily supplement the workforce or to assist in the completion of a specific project and who are temporarily scheduled to work the company's full-time schedule for a limited duration. Employment beyond any initially stated period does not in any way imply a change in employment status.

Temporary, part-time. Employees who are hired as interim replacements to temporarily supplement the workforce or to assist in the completion of a specific project and who are temporarily scheduled to work less than 30 hours weekly for a limited duration. Employment beyond any initially stated period does not in any way imply a change in employment status.

5.4 Workweek and Hours of Work

The standard workweek is from Saturday 12:00 a.m. until Friday 11:59 p.m. and generally consists of 40 work hours. Office hours are 8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., with a 30-minute lunch break. Individual work schedules may vary depending on the needs of each department.

5.4.1 Work Schedules

Most employees work a traditional 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. schedule. This is the default work schedule for all employees. With supervisor approval, an employee may work an alternate work schedule as defined below:

- 9/8/80: This schedule requires an employee to work a total of eight 9 hour days, one 8 hour day and one scheduled day off (totaling 10 days for the pay period). The preference for a day off is Monday or Friday, every other week.
- 4/10: This schedule requires an employee to work a total of four 10 hours day each week.

5.4.2 Meal and Rest Breaks

Employees are entitled to a 30-minute unpaid meal break each day. Any nonexempt employee who is required to work through a meal break will be paid for the 30-minute period. Employees are also entitled to two 15-minute rest periods each day. Meal and rest breaks will be scheduled by the department supervisor or manager.

5.5 Time Records

All employees (whether paid hourly or salaried) are required to complete accurate weekly time sheets showing all time actually worked. Timesheets are used to calculate payroll and billing and for regulatory reporting obligations IA has as a government contractor. Timesheets may be audited by the government. Therefore, it is important for timesheets to be prepared, approved and retained. At the end of each pay period, employees and their supervisors must sign the time sheet attesting to its correctness before forwarding it to the HR department. Employees can access their timesheet by logging into [QB Time \(TSheets\)](#).

5.5.1 Important Timekeeping Policies

- A timesheet must be filled out daily by all employees.
- If a change is made on a timesheet, it must be made by the employee (unless employee is unavailable) and a reason given for the change to provide an audit trail of timesheet changes.

- The timesheet must identify the project or activity the employee is working on. Common projects/activities include:
 - Direct labor – efforts on government or other customer contracts.
 - Overhead labor – training, travel, “idle time” (no direct labor available), etc.
 - G&A labor – similar to Overhead but for effort by finance/administration employees unless otherwise directed by supervisor.
 - R&D labor – efforts on internal R&D projects.
 - B&P labor – efforts on proposals for new customer contracts.
- The employee must account for all time worked whether compensated or not.
- The timesheet must be signed by the employee as true and correct. The accuracy and completeness of an employee’s timesheet is their responsibility.
- The supervisor must approve the employee’s entire timesheet.
- Adequate procedures and training shall be provided to facilitate employee understanding.

5.6 Overtime

When required due to the needs of the business, employees may be asked to work overtime. Overtime is actual hours worked in excess of 40 in a single workweek. Nonexempt employees will be paid overtime compensation at the rate of one and one-half their regular rate of pay for all hours over 40 actually worked in a single workweek. Paid leave, such as holiday, paid time off (PTO), bereavement time, and jury duty, does not apply toward work time. All overtime work must be approved in advance by a supervisor or manager.

5.7 Deductions from Pay/Safe Harbor Exempt Employees

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) does not make improper deductions from the salaries of exempt employees and complies with the salary basis requirements of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA). Employees classified as exempt from the overtime pay requirements of the FLSA will be notified of this classification at the time of hire or change in position.

Permitted deductions. The FLSA limits the types of deductions that may be made from the pay of an exempt employee. Deductions that are permitted include:

- Deductions that are required by law, e.g., income taxes;
- Deductions for employee benefits when authorized by the employee;
- Absence from work for one or more full days for personal reasons other than sickness or disability;
- Absence from work for one or more full days due to sickness or disability if the deduction is made in accordance with a bona fide plan, policy, or practice of providing compensation for salary lost due to illness;
- Offset for amounts received as witness or jury fees or for military pay;
- Unpaid disciplinary suspensions of 1 or more full days imposed in good faith for workplace conduct rule infractions; and
- Any full workweek in which the employee does not perform any work.

During the week an exempt employee begins work for the company or during the last week of employment, the employee will only be paid for actual hours worked. In addition, an employee may be paid only for hours worked during a period when the employee is using unpaid leave under the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA).

Improper deductions. If an employee classified as exempt believes that an improper deduction has been taken from the employee's pay, the employee should immediately report the deduction to the HR department. The report will be promptly investigated, and if it is found that an improper deduction has been made, the company will reimburse the employee for the improper deduction.

5.8 Paychecks

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)'s pay schedule for all employees is semi-monthly (24 paychecks per year), with paydays occurring on or before the 15th and last day of each month for the prior pay period. Each pay period contains 10 working days within the 1st and 15th and 16th through last day calendar day of each month. Full-time employees are paid for 86.67 hours on each paycheck. If payday falls on a federal holiday, employees will receive their paycheck on the preceding workday. Paychecks are directly deposited into employees' checking and/or savings accounts. Employees can access their pay stubs and maintain their employee profile by logging into [QB Workforce](#).

5.9 Bonus, Incentive, and Commission Compensation

The Company may, from time to time, establish discretionary or nondiscretionary bonus, incentive, or commission opportunities through a separate written plan, offer letter, compensation notice, or commission agreement. Unless expressly stated otherwise in the applicable written document, no employee is guaranteed any bonus, incentive payment, or commission. The Company reserves the right to interpret, amend, suspend, or discontinue any such plan or program prospectively, to the extent permitted by law.

No bonus, incentive payment, or commission is earned until all conditions stated in the applicable written plan or agreement have been satisfied. Such conditions may include, as applicable, performance metrics, timing requirements, approval steps that apply before the compensation is earned, reconciliation terms, and any active-employment requirement that lawfully applies to unearned amounts. Once compensation is earned or vested under the applicable written plan or agreement, it will be paid in accordance with that plan or agreement and applicable law and will not be forfeited to the extent prohibited by law.

Any change to bonus, incentive, or commission terms will be made prospectively and communicated in writing as required by applicable law.

Employees who are paid commissions will receive a separate written commission agreement whenever required by law and as otherwise adopted by the Company. Any such agreement will describe how commissions are calculated, when they are earned, when they are paid, how any draw or reconciliation works if applicable, and how commissions are treated upon separation from employment.

For nonexempt employees, nondiscretionary bonuses and incentive payments will be included in the regular rate of pay and overtime calculations to the extent required by federal or state law.

5.10 Access to Personnel Files

Employee files are maintained by the company and are considered confidential. Managers and supervisors may only have access to personnel file information on a need-to-know basis. Employees may inspect their own personnel files and may copy them but may not remove documents from their file. Inspections by employees must be requested in writing to the HR department and will be scheduled at a mutually convenient time or as

required under state law. Representatives of government or law enforcement agencies, in the course of their duties, may be allowed access to file information.

5.11 Employment of Relatives and Domestic Partners

Relatives and domestic partners may be hired by the company if (1) the persons concerned will not work in a direct supervisory relationship, and (2) the employment will not pose difficulties for supervision, security, safety, or morale. For the purposes of this policy, “relatives” are defined as spouses, children, siblings, parents, or grandparents. A “domestic partnership” is generally defined as a committed relationship between two individuals who are sharing a home or living arrangements.

Current employees who marry each other or become involved in a domestic partnership will be permitted to continue employment with the company provided they don’t work in a direct supervisory relationship with each other or otherwise pose difficulties as mentioned above. If employees who marry or live together do work in a direct supervisory relationship with each other, the company will attempt to reassign one of the employees to another position for which the employee is qualified if such a position is available. If no such position is available, the employees will be permitted to determine which one of them will resign from the company.

5.12 Separation from Employment

In all cases of voluntary resignation (one initiated by the employee), employees are asked to provide a written notice to their supervisors at least 10 working days in advance of the last day of work. Holidays and PTO will not be counted toward the 10-day notice. Employees who provide the requested amount of notice will be considered to have resigned in good standing and generally will be eligible for rehire.

In most cases, a company representative will conduct an exit meeting on or before the last day of employment to collect all company property and to discuss final pay. Final paychecks will be disbursed on the employee’s last day of employment, or as required by law. If applicable, information regarding benefits continuation through the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA) will be sent to the employee’s home address. Should it become necessary because of business conditions to reduce the number of employees or work hours, this will be done at the discretion of the company.

5.13 Biometric Information

IA may collect limited biometric information from employees, specifically fingerprints, as required for federal background investigations and security clearance processing conducted by the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) or other authorized government agencies.

Collection and purpose. IA collects fingerprints solely for the purpose of government-mandated background investigations and security clearance adjudication. No biometric data is collected for timekeeping, facility access, or any other commercial purpose.

Storage and retention. IA does not independently store biometric data. Fingerprint data is submitted directly to the authorized government agency (e.g., DCSA) and is not retained by IA beyond the submission process. Any biometric data temporarily in IA’s possession during the submission process is treated as sensitive personally identifiable information (PII), stored securely with access limited to authorized personnel, and destroyed promptly after submission.

Prohibition on sale or trade. IA will not sell, lease, trade, or otherwise profit from employee biometric data. IA will not use biometric information for any purpose other than the government-mandated background investigation process described above.

Employee notice and consent. Employees will be informed in writing prior to any biometric data collection, including the specific purpose of collection, the government agency to which the data will be submitted, and the anticipated handling and destruction timeline. Employees are required to provide written acknowledgment of this policy prior to biometric data collection.

This policy complies with applicable state biometric privacy laws, including the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA/CPRA), and any other applicable requirements in jurisdictions where IA employees reside (currently CA, GA, MA, NH, NM, and NY).

5.14 Arbitration for Employment-Related Claims

IA does not require employees or applicants to agree to mandatory arbitration as a condition of employment. Consistent with IA's obligations as a U.S. Department of Defense contractor under DFARS 252.222-7006, IA will not enforce any agreement requiring employees or subcontractors to arbitrate claims arising under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 or any tort related to or arising out of sexual assault or harassment. See Section 10.3 (Employee Rights & Whistleblower Protection) for additional detail on applicable contract clause requirements.

Should IA and an employee mutually agree to voluntary arbitration of any employment-related dispute, such agreement will be documented in writing and signed by both parties. Voluntary arbitration does not waive any employee's right to file a charge with the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC) or any other federal, state, or local government agency.

6 Workplace Safety

6.1 Drug-Free and Alcohol-Free Workplace

It is the policy of Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA, or "the company") to maintain a safe and healthy workplace that is free of the effects of drug abuse. As a government contractor, this policy is intended to meet the regulatory requirements of FAR 52.226-7 Drug-Free Workplace. This policy covers all employees while conducting IA business whether on or off the company's premises and vendors and guests on the premises of the company or at IA related events or meetings. Violation of any part of this policy by an employee may result in corrective action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employees, vendors and guests of IA are prohibited from the use, sale, dispensing, distribution, possession, manufacture, or being under the influence of drugs that are illegal under any federal, state or local law, including marijuana (and medical marijuana), prescription drugs without a valid prescription, inhalants, or narcotic substances on the company's premises, at IA events or while conducting IA business, whether on or off the company's premises. In addition, employees are prohibited from the possession, use or sale of illegal

drugs because such activities adversely affect job performance, job safety, or the company's reputation in the community.

The illegal or unauthorized use of prescription drugs is prohibited. It is a violation of this Drug-Free Workplace Policy to intentionally misuse and/or abuse prescription medications.

Appropriate corrective action will be taken if job performance deteriorates, if the use of a substance prevents or is a contributing factor in causing the employee to not be able to fully perform their job, if accidents occur or if the employee constitutes a threat to the property or safety of the company, co-workers or others.

Prescription and over-the-counter drugs are not prohibited when taken in standard dosage and/or according to a physician's prescription. Any employee taking prescribed or over-the-counter medications is responsible for consulting the prescribing physician and/or pharmacist to ascertain whether the medication may interfere with the safe performance of his/her job. If the use of a medication could compromise the safety of the employee, fellow employees or the public, it is the employee's responsibility to use appropriate personnel procedures (e.g., call in sick, use leave, request change of duty, notify supervisor) to avoid unsafe workplace practices.

Employees are required to notify their supervisor and/or the Chief Financial Officer within five calendar days should they receive a conviction for a violation of a criminal drug statute in the workplace or a conviction for operating a motor vehicle while under the influence.

Vendors will be subject to penalties that may include loss of contract for violation of this policy. Guests will be subject to being barred from IA activities.

Employees who are experiencing work-related concerns resulting from substance abuse or dependency may request, or be required, to seek counseling or other appropriate assistance from IA sponsored Employee Assistance Program. _Failure to cooperate with, complete or maintain an agreed-upon treatment plan may result in corrective action, up to and including termination. Participation in a treatment program does not insulate an employee from corrective action for a violation(s) of this or other IA policies.

The Employee Assistance Program is available to provide free and confidential counseling and information regarding the dangers of substance abuse in the workplace. Additionally, medical treatment is available to employees participating in the group insurance plans under the terms of those plans. In accordance with IA's leave policies, any employee may request a leave of absence to undertake rehabilitation treatment and be provided protections as noted within the applicable leave.

6.2 Smoke-Free Workplace

Smoking is not allowed in company buildings or work areas at any time. "Smoking" includes the use of any tobacco products (including chewing tobacco), electronic smoking devices, and e-cigarettes. Smoking is permitted during break times in designated outdoor areas. Employees using these areas are expected to dispose of any smoking debris safely and properly.

6.3 Alcohol-Free Workplace

Alcohol is not to be consumed during business hours in company buildings or work areas unless it is during a company social event. Consuming alcohol with clients is allowable. Employees are encouraged to drink

responsibly and use alternate transportation after drinking alcohol to ensure personal and public safety. Employees are prohibited from operating company vehicles after consumption of any alcohol.

6.4 Workplace Violence Prevention

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) is committed to providing a safe, violence-free workplace for our employees. Due to this commitment, the company discourages employees from engaging in any physical confrontation with a violent or potentially violent individual or from behaving in a threatening or violent manner. Threats, threatening language, or any other acts of aggression or violence made toward or by any employee will not be tolerated. A threat may include any verbal or physical harassment or abuse; attempts to intimidate others; menacing gestures; stalking; or any other hostile, aggressive, and/or destructive actions taken for the purposes of intimidation. This policy covers any violent or potentially violent behavior that occurs in the workplace or at company-sponsored functions.

All IA employees bear the responsibility of keeping our work environment free from violence or potential violence. Any employee who witnesses or is the recipient of violent behavior should promptly inform their supervisor, manager, or HR department. All threats will be promptly investigated. No employee will be subject to retaliation, intimidation, or discipline as a result of reporting a threat in good faith under this guideline. Any individual engaging in violence or threat of violence against the company, its employees, or its property will be prosecuted to the full extent of the law. All acts will be investigated, and the appropriate action will be taken. Any such act or threatening behavior may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. The company reserves the right to inspect all belongings of employees on its premises, including packages, briefcases, purses and handbags, gym bags, and personal vehicles on company property. In addition, IA may inspect the contents of lockers, storage areas, file cabinets, desks, and workstations at any time and may remove all company property and other items that are in violation of company rules and policies.

6.5 Commitment to Safety

Protecting the safety of our employees and visitors is the most important aspect of running our business. All employees have the opportunity and responsibility to contribute to a safe work environment by using commonsense rules and safe practices and by notifying management when any health or safety issues are present. All employees are encouraged to partner with management to ensure maximum safety for all. In the event of an emergency, notify the appropriate emergency personnel by calling 9-1-1.

Any workplace injury, accident, or illness must be reported to the employee's supervisor as soon as possible, regardless of the severity of the injury or accident.

6.6 International Travel Security Measures

IA does not assign employees to work locations outside the United States. However, employees may travel internationally for personal reasons. The following preventive and security measures apply to all employees traveling outside the U.S.

Employees holding security clearances. IA follows National Industrial Security Program Operating Manual (NISPOM) requirements for international travel. Cleared employees must submit a foreign travel request through the Facility Security Officer (FSO) prior to departure. Pre-travel and post-travel security briefings are

mandatory. Employees must report all foreign contacts, suspicious approaches, and any attempts at elicitation to the FSO. Refer to IA's Standard Practice Procedures (SPP) and DCSA initial/annual security training materials for detailed requirements and reporting procedures.

All employees (including non-cleared personnel). As a matter of company policy, IA extends the same pre-travel and post-travel briefing process to all employees to maintain a consistent security posture across the organization. All employees traveling internationally should:

- Notify their supervisor and the FSO prior to international travel.
- View a pre-travel security briefing covering awareness of social engineering, elicitation techniques, and country-specific risks.
- Do not bring company-issued devices or any device containing Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) on international travel unless explicitly approved by IA leadership.
- Avoid connecting to unsecured public Wi-Fi networks for any work-related communication.
- Be aware of export control restrictions—do not carry technical data or controlled information across international borders without prior written authorization (see Section 10.16, Export Controls).
- Report any suspicious contacts, unusual approaches, or security concerns to the FSO and leadership upon return.
- Perform post-travel debrief.

These measures are intended to protect both the employee's personal safety and IA's obligations as a DoD contractor handling CUI and classified information.

6.7 Crisis Management

IA maintains a formal crisis management plan to address potential disruptions to business operations, employee safety, and security-related risks including kidnap for ransom, extortion, and detention. The plan addresses the following areas:

Cybersecurity incidents. Handled per DFARS 252.204-7012 requirements, including 72-hour reporting to the DoD Cyber Crime Center (DC3) and immediate internal notification to IA leadership. Employees must report any suspected cyber incident—including unauthorized access or data loss—to leadership and the IT security team without delay. See Section 10.7 (Information Security & Acceptable IT Use) for specific protocols.

Physical security incidents. For employees on military installations, follow base emergency procedures and immediately notify IA leadership. For remote employees or employees at the office, contact local emergency services (911) and notify IA leadership as soon as safely possible.

Security-related risks. In the unlikely event an employee faces kidnap, extortion, detention, or similar threats—whether domestic or during personal international travel—the employee (or their emergency contact) should notify IA leadership immediately. IA will coordinate with appropriate government agencies and security resources to assist.

Business continuity. In the event of extended disruption, leadership will communicate alternative work arrangements to all affected employees.

Communication chain. All crisis events must be reported immediately to the employee's supervisor and a member of the leadership team. Leadership will coordinate response activities, notifications to government

customers as contractually required, and external communications. Employees should not make public statements about any crisis event without prior authorization from leadership.

7 Workplace Guidelines

7.1 Attendance

All employees are expected to arrive on time, ready to work, every day they are scheduled to work. If unable to arrive at work on time, or if an employee will be absent for an entire day, the employee must contact their supervisor as soon as possible. Excessive absenteeism or tardiness will result in discipline up to and including termination. Failure to show up or call in for a scheduled shift without prior approval also may result in discipline up to and including termination. If an employee fails to report to work or call in to inform the supervisor of the absence for three consecutive days or more, the employee will be considered to have voluntarily resigned employment, except where the absence is protected by law (including FMLA, ADA, USERRA, pregnancy, workers' compensation, or applicable state leave laws) or where notice was not reasonably possible. Before treating any absence as a voluntary resignation, IA will make reasonable efforts to contact the employee.

7.2 Job Performance

Communication between employees and supervisors or managers is very important. Discussions regarding job performance are ongoing and often informal. Employees should initiate conversations with their supervisors if they feel additional ongoing feedback is needed.

Generally, formal performance reviews are conducted annually. These reviews include a written performance appraisal and discussion between the employee and the supervisor about job performance and expectations for the coming year.

7.3 Outside Employment

Employees generally are permitted to work a second job as long as it does not interfere with their job performance or create a conflict of interest with Interactive Aptitude LLC. All employees, including part-time employees, must obtain prior approval from their supervisor and/or a leadership team member before undertaking any outside employment or other work activity. The purpose of company approval is to ensure no conflict of interest exists which violate company policies or customer contracts.

Employees with a second job are expected to work their assigned schedules. A second job will not be considered an excuse for poor job performance, absenteeism, tardiness, leaving early, refusal to travel, or refusal to work overtime or different hours. In addition, employees who have accepted outside employment may not use paid sick time to work on the outside job. However, an employee on a leave of absence may continue to work in the outside job if this employment has been approved by the company under this policy and the employee's reason for leave does not preclude the outside employment.

If outside work activity causes or contributes to job-related problems, it must be discontinued, or the employee may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

7.4 Dress and Grooming

Interactive Aptitude LLC provides a casual yet professional work environment for its employees. Even though the dress code is casual, it is important to project a professional image to our customers, visitors, and coworkers. All employees are expected to dress in a manner consistent with good hygiene, safety, and good taste. Please use common sense.

Certain employees may be required to meet special dress and grooming, such as wearing uniforms or safety equipment/clothing, depending on the nature of their job. Any questions or complaints regarding the appropriateness of attire should be directed to the CFO. Decisions regarding attire will be made by the CFO and not by individual departments or managers.

7.5 Cell Phone Safety and Driving

Safe driving is the first priority when operating a vehicle while driving on Interactive Aptitude LLC business. Employees' first responsibility is to pay attention to their driving. They should never allow a cell phone or other mobile device to distract them from concentrating on driving.

Under no circumstances should employees feel that they need to place themselves or others at risk while driving to fulfill business needs. Employees should follow these procedures to avoid distracted driving:

- Follow all applicable state and local laws that address the use of cell phones and other mobile devices while driving.
- Avoid using cell phones while driving and avoid it as a hand-held device. Find a safe place to pull over to make or receive phone calls, send or receive text messages, or manipulate navigation apps.
- Program their destination into navigation apps or GPS devices before they start driving.
- Do not read or respond to text messages or e-mail or browse social media or the Internet while driving. The prohibition on text messaging while driving is intended to comply with FAR 52.226-8 Encouraging Contractor Policies to Ban Text Messaging While Driving.
- Be aware of distractions from in-car "infotainment" systems. Just because they are built into the vehicle does not mean they do not create a hazardous distraction.

Employees who fail to follow safety guidelines are subject to discipline.

For any employees operating vehicles for work purposes (on client site, renting a car, etc.), they must maintain their own primary auto insurance meeting state minimums.

7.6 Social Media Acceptable Use

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) encourages employees to share information with coworkers and with those outside the company for the purposes of gathering information, generating new ideas, and learning from the work of others. Social media provides inexpensive, informal, and timely ways to participate in an exchange of ideas and information. However, information posted on a website is available to the public, and therefore, the company has established the following guidelines for employee participation in social media.

Note: As used in this policy, "social media" refers to blogs, forums, and social networking sites, such as Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, Instagram, and Snapchat, among others.

Off-duty use of social media. Employees may maintain personal websites or weblogs on their own time using their own facilities. Employees must ensure that social media activity does not interfere with their work. In general, the company considers social media activities to be personal endeavors, and employees may use them to express their thoughts or promote their ideas. In addition, employees may not post on a personal blog or webpage or participate on a social networking platform for personal purposes during work time or at any time with IA equipment or property.

On-duty use of social media. Employees may engage in social media activity during work time provided it does not identify or reference company clients, customers, programs, or vendors without express permission. The company monitors employee use of company computers and the Internet, including employee blogging and social networking activity.

Respect. Demonstrate respect for the dignity of the company, its owners, its customers, its vendors, and its employees. A social media site is a public place, and employees should avoid inappropriate comments. For example, employees should not divulge IA confidential information such as trade secrets, client lists, or information restricted from disclosure by law on social media sites. Similarly, employees should not engage in harassing or discriminatory behavior that targets other employees or individuals because of their protected class status or make defamatory comments or engage in other behavior that violates the company's policies.

Post disclaimers. A disclaimer is required whenever a reasonable reader could mistake an employee's personal statement for an official communication of the company. This typically arises when an employee:

- identifies themselves as a company employee in the same post or profile context where they are commenting on the company, its clients, its competitors, its industry, or matters related to the company's business; or
- holds a public-facing or senior role such that their views are likely to be perceived as the company's views; or
- is posting on a channel, account, or thread that a reader could reasonably mistake for an official company channel.

When a disclaimer is required, it should appear in a clearly visible location near the relevant content — for example, in the post itself, in a pinned post, or in the profile bio of the account where the discussion is taking place. Suggested wording: "The views expressed are mine alone and do not necessarily reflect the views of my employer."

A disclaimer is not required for ordinary personal social media activity that does not concern the company — for example, posts about hobbies, personal interests, family, sports, politics, or other topics unrelated to the company's business — even if the employee's profile mentions where they work.

Employees should keep in mind that a disclaimer does not shield them from disciplinary action if a post violates company policy or federal, state, or local law.

Competition. Employees should not use social media to criticize the company's competition and should not use it to compete with the company.

Confidentiality. Employees should not identify or reference company clients, customers, or vendors without express permission. Employees may write about their jobs in general but may not disclose any confidential or proprietary information. For examples of confidential information, employees should refer to the confidentiality policy. When in doubt, ask before publishing.

New ideas. Employees should remember that new ideas related to work or the company's business belong to the company. Do not post them on a social media site without the company's permission.

Trademarks and copyrights. Employees should not use the company's or others' trademarks on a social media site or reproduce the company's or others' material without first obtaining permission.

Legal. Employees are expected to comply with all applicable laws, including, but not limited to, Federal Trade Commission (FTC) guidelines and copyright, trademark, and harassment laws.

Forward-looking and confidential business statements. Employees should not post, on any social media platform, statements about IA's projected growth, sales, profits, future products or services, marketing plans, customer lists, contract terms, or any other non-public business information. Employees may write about their jobs in general terms but must not disclose confidential or proprietary information. When in doubt, ask before publishing.

Discipline. Violations of this policy may result in discipline up to and including immediate termination of employment.

Nothing in this policy is meant to, nor should it be interpreted to, in any way limit employees' rights under any applicable federal, state, or local laws, including rights under the NLRA to engage in protected concerted activities with other employees to improve or discuss terms and conditions of employment, such as wages, working conditions, and benefits. Employees have the right to engage in or refrain from such activities.

7.7 Solicitation

Employees should be able to work in an environment that is free from unnecessary annoyances and interference with their work. In order to protect our employees and visitors, solicitation by employees is strictly prohibited while either the employee being solicited or the employee doing the soliciting is on "working time."

"Working time" is defined as time during which an employee is not at a meal, on break, or on the premises immediately before or after a shift.

Employees are also prohibited from distributing written materials, handbills, or any other type of literature on working time and, at all times, in "working areas," which include all office areas. "Working areas" do not include break rooms, parking lots, or common areas shared by employees during nonworking time.

Nonemployees may not trespass or solicit or distribute materials anywhere on company property at any time.

Nothing in this policy is meant to, nor should it be interpreted to, in any way limit employees' rights under any applicable federal, state, or local laws, including rights under the NLRA to engage in protected concerted activities with other employees to improve or discuss terms and conditions of employment, such as wages, working conditions, and benefits. Employees have the right to engage in or refrain from such activities.

7.8 Computers, Internet, E-Mail, and Other Resources

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) provides a wide variety of communication tools and resources to employees for use in running day-to-day business activities. Whether it is the telephone, voicemail, scanner, Internet, intranet, e-mail, text messaging, portable electronic devices, or any other company-provided technology, use should be reserved for business-related matters during working hours. All communication using these tools should be handled in a professional and respectful manner.

Employees should not have any expectation of privacy in their use of company computer, phone, portable electronic devices, or other communication tools. All communications made using company-provided

equipment or services, including e-mail and Internet activity, are subject to inspection by the company. Employees should keep in mind that even if they delete an e-mail, a voicemail, or another communication, a copy may be archived on the company's systems.

Employee use of company-provided communication systems, including personal e-mail and Internet use, that is not job-related has the potential to drain, rather than enhance, productivity and system performance. You should also be aware that information transmitted through e-mail and the Internet is not completely secure or may contain viruses or malware, and information you transmit and receive could damage the company's systems, as well as the reputation and/or competitiveness of the company. To protect against possible problems, delete any e-mail messages before opening that are received from unknown senders and advertisers. It also is against company policy to turn off antivirus protection software or make unauthorized changes to system configurations installed on company computers. Violations of this policy may result in termination for a first offense.

The company encourages employees to use e-mail only to communicate with fellow employees, suppliers, customers, or potential customers regarding company business. Internal and external e-mails are considered business records and may be subject to federal and state recordkeeping requirements, as well as to discovery in the event of litigation. Be aware of this possibility when sending e-mails within and outside the company. All use of company-provided communications systems, including e-mail and Internet use, should conform to our company guidelines/policies, including but not limited to the Equal Opportunity, Harassment, Confidential Information, and Conflicts of Interest. So, for example, employees should not engage in harassing or discriminatory behavior that targets other employees or individuals because of their protected class status or make defamatory comments. Similarly, employees should not divulge confidential information such as trade secrets, client lists, or information restricted from disclosure by law on social media sites.

Because e-mail, telephone and voicemail, and Internet communication equipment are provided for company business purposes and are critical to the company's success, your communications may be accessed without further notice by IT department administrators and company management to ensure compliance with this guideline.

The electronic communication systems are not secure and may allow inadvertent disclosure, accidental transmission to third parties, etc. Sensitive information should not be sent via unsecured electronic means. Employees should pay particular care to the use and security of portable electronic devices when used for business-related purposes, such as laptops, tablets, smartphones, and other data storage media, whether provided by the employer or the employee. Lost or stolen portable electronic devices containing company information may cause breaches of security that result in the loss of company confidential commercial data, the loss of vital research data, the unauthorized disclosure of sensitive employee data, lawsuits against the individual, and lawsuits against the company. Employees should use appropriate password protections for such devices and physically secure them as recommended by IT department administrators.

Office telephones are for business purposes. While the company recognizes that some personal calls are necessary, these should be kept as brief as possible and to a minimum. Personal use of the company's cell phones, long-distance account, or toll-free numbers is strictly prohibited. Abuse of these privileges is subject to corrective action up to and including termination.

The company reserves the right to monitor customer calls to ensure employees abide by company quality guidelines and provide appropriate levels of customer service. Should the subject matter of any telephone

conversation become personal while monitoring is taking place, monitoring of the call will immediately be discontinued.

Nothing in this policy is meant to, nor should it be interpreted to, in any way limit employees' rights under any applicable federal, state, or local laws, including rights under the NLRA to engage in protected concerted activities with other employees to improve or discuss terms and conditions of employment, such as wages, working conditions, and benefits. Employees have the right to engage in or refrain from such activities.

7.9 Disciplinary Procedure

IA expects employees to meet the company's standards of behavior and performance, and to address any shortfall promptly. Most issues are best resolved through a direct conversation between the employee and their supervisor, and IA generally favors that approach over formal discipline.

When formal discipline is appropriate, IA may use any of the following measures, in any order and combination, depending on the nature and severity of the issue:

- Informal discussion — a direct conversation about the issue and what needs to change. The supervisor should make a brief written note of the conversation.
- Written warning — a written notice describing the issue, the required correction, a timeline, and the consequences of failing to improve. A copy is placed in the employee's personnel file.
- Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) — at the company's discretion, a written plan setting out expectations, goals, resources, a review period, and possible consequences of failing to improve.
- Suspension — temporary removal from the workplace, with or without pay. For exempt (salaried) employees, unpaid suspensions generally must be either a full workweek or tied to a written workplace-conduct rule, such as a policy against harassment or workplace violence.
- Termination — failure to correct an issue, or any single act of serious misconduct, may result in termination.

IA may skip, repeat, modify, extend, or discontinue any of these steps. A PIP is not required before discipline or termination. Nothing in this policy creates a contract of employment or alters the at-will employment relationship.

Serious misconduct. Conduct such as harassment, violence or threats, theft, dishonesty, gross insubordination, breach of confidentiality, intoxication on duty, or any violation of law may result in immediate suspension or termination without prior steps. In such cases the supervisor — in consultation with the CEO — will typically suspend the employee pending an investigation, and IA will determine next steps based on the findings.

Protected-rights review. Before issuing or enforcing discipline where the underlying issue may relate to disability, pregnancy, religion, protected leave, workplace injury, legally protected complaint activity, wage-and-hour concerns, whistleblowing, or other protected rights, management will review applicable accommodation, leave, and anti-retaliation obligations before proceeding.

7.10 Workplace Civility

IA is committed to maintaining a professional, courteous, and respectful workplace. All employees, supervisors, and managers are expected to treat others with dignity and respect in all work-related interactions, whether in person, remote, or electronic.

Workplace civility expectations include, but are not limited to: communicating respectfully and professionally with colleagues, supervisors, clients, and vendors; refraining from bullying, intimidation, or other behavior that demeans or marginalizes others; avoiding gossip, public criticism of colleagues, or behavior designed to undermine another employee's reputation or work; and being mindful of the impact of one's words and actions on others, including in emails, messages, and virtual meetings.

Behavior that falls short of these expectations may not rise to the level of unlawful harassment but still undermines a productive and healthy workplace. Such behavior may result in corrective action under the Disciplinary Procedure (Section 7.10). Employees who experience or witness uncivil behavior are encouraged to report it to their supervisor, HR, or through the Employee Complaint and Grievance Procedure (Section 3.1).

8 Time Off and Leaves of Absence

8.1 Holidays

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) observes and allows time off with pay for the following holidays:

- New Year's Day
- Martin Luther King, Jr. Day
- Presidents' Day
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Indigenous Peoples' Day
- Veterans Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Christmas

Any additional holidays will be designated by the company at the start of each calendar year.

If one of these holidays falls on a Sunday, it will be observed on the following Monday. If the holiday falls on a Saturday, the company will select either the following Monday or the preceding Friday as a substitute holiday. The company reserves the right to pay eligible employees in lieu of time off if the holiday falls on Saturday. Holiday pay. Full-time regular employees are eligible for holiday pay. Hourly nonexempt employees become eligible after they have been actively with the company for three months. Exempt salaried employees may receive holiday pay immediately upon joining the company.

Holiday pay shall be at the employee's regular straight-time rate, inclusive of shift premiums, times the employee's regularly scheduled hours (not to exceed eight hours).

To receive holiday pay, an eligible nonexempt employee must be at work or taking an approved absence on the workdays immediately preceding and immediately following the day on which the holiday is observed. An approved absence is a day of paid vacation or paid sick leave. If an employee is absent on one or both of these days because of an illness or injury, the company may require verification of the reason for the absence before approving holiday pay.

Religious observances. Employees who need time off to observe religious practices or holidays not already scheduled by the company should speak with their supervisor. Depending upon business needs, the employee may be able to work on a day that is normally observed as a holiday and then take time off for another religious day. Employees may also be able to take vacation time, or take off unpaid days. The company will seek to reasonably accommodate individuals' religious observances.

8.2 Vacation

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) recognizes the importance of time off from work to relax, spend time with family, and enjoy leisure activities. The company provides paid vacation time to full-time employees for this purpose, and employees are encouraged to take vacation during the year. Part-time employees who are regularly scheduled to work 20 or more hours per week will be eligible for paid vacation on a pro rata schedule. Employees will accrue paid vacation according to the terms of their employment offer letter or employment contract, if applicable.

Employees may not take paid vacation until they actually have earned or accrued the vacation time. New employees accrue paid vacation at the start of employment but may not take any vacation until they have completed at least three months of employment.

Generally, employees should submit vacation plans to their supervisor at least four weeks in advance of the requested vacation date. Vacation may be scheduled in increments of 1 full workday up to a maximum of two weeks in a row. Managers have the right to designate when some or all of vacations must be taken because of business needs.

Vacation should be used in the year it is earned. Employees will be permitted to carry over up to five days of accrued vacation to the following calendar year, but the carryover vacation must be used by March 31 of the following year. Where applicable state law prohibits forfeiture of accrued vacation (for example, California), accrued unused vacation will not be forfeited and will be paid out at separation as required by law. In all other jurisdictions, unused accrued vacation will be paid out at separation only as expressly required by law or by a written agreement signed by an officer of the company.

Employees whose employment terminates will be paid for unused vacation time that has accrued during the calendar year of the termination.

8.3 Sick Leave

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) provides regular, full-time, and part-time employees with paid sick days. A minimum of 40 hours of paid sick time is offered to all employees. Employees become eligible for sick days immediately after beginning employment.

Sick days are not intended to be used as a substitute for vacation days, but sick days may be used if an employee needs to provide care for a family member who is ill. Sick days may also be used if an employee needs time off for scheduled medical procedures.

Employees may carry accrued sick days over from one year to the next. However, the maximum cap for sick time is 80 hours.

If the need for sick leave is foreseeable, employees are required to give at least 30 days' advance notice (e.g., a planned medical treatment) whenever possible. If the need for sick leave is not foreseeable, employees are asked to notify their supervisor as soon as is practical.

If an employee misses three or more consecutive days because of illness, IA may require the employee to provide a physician's written permission to return to work.

Except as required by state law, unused sick days are forfeited when an employee's employment ends for any reason.

8.4 Family and Medical Leave

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) complies with family and medical leave laws as required. Although the Company is generally exempt from the federal Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA), state laws for California, Massachusetts, and New York are applicable. FMLA provides unpaid leave and job protection for up to 12 weeks. State laws usually provide for this and more, including paid leave funded by employee or employer-paid payroll taxes. Other federal laws may cover leave, for example the Americans with Disabilities Act, or the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (covered below in Section 8.5).

If an employee believes family and/or medical leave is necessary, they are encouraged to discuss options with their supervisor and/or the CFO to ensure job coverage while they will be on leave and to take advantage of paid leave provided by state programs and Company-paid benefits.

8.5 Military Leave

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) supports the military obligations of all employees and grants leaves for uniformed service in accordance with applicable federal and state laws. Any employee who needs time off for uniformed service should immediately notify the HR department and the employee's supervisor, who will provide details regarding the leave. If an employee is unable to provide notice before leaving for uniformed service, a family member should notify the supervisor as soon as possible.

Upon return from military leave, employees will retain certain rights with respect to reinstatement, seniority, layoffs, compensation, length of service promotions, and length of service pay increases, as required by applicable federal or state law. Failure to report for work within the prescribed time after completion of military service will be considered a voluntary termination.

8.6 Bereavement Leave

Employees with more than three months' service may take up to three days of paid bereavement leave upon the death of a member of their immediate family. "Immediate family members" are defined as an employee's spouse, domestic partner, parents, stepparents, siblings, children, stepchildren, grandparent, parent-in-law, brother-in-law, sister-in-law, son-in-law, daughter-in-law, or grandchild. All regular, full-time employees may take up to one day off with pay to attend the funeral of an extended family member (aunts, uncles, and cousins). The company may require verification of the need for the leave. The employee's supervisor and HR will consider this time off on a case-by-case basis.

Payment for bereavement leave is computed at the regular hourly rate to a maximum of eight hours for one day in addition to sick leave if taken. Time off granted in accordance with this policy shall not be credited as time worked for the purpose of computing overtime.

8.7 Jury Duty/Court Appearance

The company supports employees in their civic duty to serve on a jury. Employees must present any summons to jury duty to their supervisor as soon as possible after receiving the notice to allow advance planning for an employee's absence.

Employees will be provided time off for jury duty in accordance with applicable laws. If an employee is released from jury duty after four hours or less of service, the employee must report to work for the remainder of that workday. If an employee is granted paid time off for jury duty and also receives a payment from the court, the court's payment should be paid over to IA. Please endorse the check and then send it to the CFO. The employee may decline payment from the court on behalf of IA if given the option.

Time for appearance in court for personal business will be the individual employee's responsibility. Employees should use vacation days for this purpose.

8.8 Time Off for Voting

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) recognizes that voting is a right and privilege of being a citizen of the United States and encourages employees to exercise their right to vote. In almost all cases, employees will have sufficient time outside working hours to vote. If for any reason an employee thinks this will not be the case, they should contact their supervisor to discuss scheduling accommodations.

8.9 Domestic Violence Leave

Employees with more than three months' service may be granted up to three (3) days of unpaid leave in any 12-month period if the employee or a family or household member of the employee is the victim of domestic violence. Such leave may be used to seek an injunction, obtain counseling or services from a victim-services organization, to make the home secure or seek new housing, or to seek legal assistance arising from the active of domestic violence.

9 Employee Benefits

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) recognizes the value of benefits to employees and their families. The company supports employees by offering a comprehensive and competitive benefits program. For more information regarding benefit programs, please refer to the company Summary Plan Descriptions (SPDs), which are found on the company intranet, or contact the HR department. To the extent the information provided here conflicts with the SPD or full plan document, the full plan document will control.

9.1 Health Reimbursement Arrangement

Full-time employees are eligible for an Individual Care Health Reimbursement Arrangement (ICHRA), commonly known as an “HRA”. Each eligible employee receives a monthly allowance which may be used to pay for eligible expenses. PeopleKeep is the designated benefit administrator who reviews expenses submitted by employees and informs the CFO of amounts eligible for reimbursement. Reimbursements are paid on regular paychecks following approval by PeopleKeep. Employees may access their HRA account by logging into [PeopleKeep](#).

9.2 401(k) Plan

Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA) recognizes the importance of saving for retirement and offers eligible employees a 401(k) plan. Eligibility, vesting, and all other matters relating to these plans are explained in the SPD that can be obtained from the CFO. Employees may access their 401(k) by logging into Vestwell.

9.3 Workers’ Compensation

Workers’ compensation is a “no-fault” system that provides compensation for medical expenses and wage losses to employees who are injured or who become ill because of employment.

Interactive Aptitude LLC pays the entire cost of workers’ compensation insurance. The insurance provides coverage for related medical and rehabilitation expenses and a portion of lost wages to employees who sustain an injury on the job.

The company abides by all applicable state workers’ compensation laws and regulations.

If an employee sustains a job-related injury or illness, it is important to notify the supervisor and HR immediately. The supervisor will complete an injury report with input from the employee and return the form to the HR department. HR will file the claim with the insurance company. In cases of true medical emergencies, report to the nearest emergency room.

Workers’ compensation benefits (paid or unpaid) will run concurrently with FMLA leave, if applicable, where permitted by state and federal law. In addition, employees will not be paid vacation or sick leave for approved absences covered by the company’s workers’ compensation program, except to supplement the workers’ compensation benefits such as when the plan only covers a portion of the employees’ salary as allowed by state law.

9.4 Employee Assistance Program

Interactive Aptitude LLC wants employees to be able to maintain a healthy balance of work and family that allows them to enjoy life. The employee assistance program (EAP) is a resource designed to provide highly confidential and experienced help for employees in dealing with issues that affect their lives and the quality of their job performance. The EAP is a confidential counseling and referral service that can help employees successfully deal with life’s challenges.

This free, comprehensive counseling service offers employees three visits per issue each year and a 24-hour hotline answered by professional, degreed counselors. For legal or financial issues, employees receive a discount on any services that might be needed.

The company encourages employees to use this valuable service whenever they have such a need. Employees who choose to use these counseling services are assured the information disclosed in their sessions is confidential and not available to the company, and the company is not given any information on who chooses to use the services. For questions or additional information about this program, employees may contact the HR department. Employees may access the EAP resources by logging into [Thrive](#).

10 Contract Clauses Directly Related to Employees

A performs work for U.S. Federal and Defense customers and must comply with the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and the Defense FAR Supplement (DFARS). This section distills applicable clauses from our contracts into plain-language take-aways so every employee understands day-to-day expectations. References to the controlling clauses appear at the end of each section and serve as the governing source. The plain-language commentary in this section is provided for employee convenience only; in the event of any conflict between the commentary and the controlling clause, the clause governs. Employees performing work on a federal contract must familiarize themselves with the specific FAR and DFARS clauses incorporated into that contract. Where any contract clause conflicts with, or imposes additional or stricter requirements than, the summary in this section, the contract clause governs. Employees should raise any apparent conflict, or any uncertainty about which clauses apply, with their supervisor.

10.1 Prohibited Software, Equipment & Apps

You may not use, install, connect, or subscribe to any product or service that is barred by the U.S. Government—whether you are on-site, teleworking, or using an IA-issued or personal device for company business.

- Do not use security products from Kaspersky Lab.
- Do not use hardware, software, or cloud services from Huawei, ZTE, Hytera Communications, Hangzhou Hikvision, or Dahua Technology.
- Do not install or access ByteDance/TikTok (including SDKs, plug-ins, or web versions) on any device that touches IA data or networks.
- Do not procure, lease, or connect any telecommunications equipment or service produced or provided by an entity from China or Russia.
- If you are unsure about a product's origin, stop and contact FSO, CTO or CFO.
- Prohibits contractors from acquiring or using goods, services, or equipment from countries or entities sanctioned by the U.S. Government, including those subject to trade restrictions, embargoes, or terrorism support designations.

Applicable Clauses:

- [FAR 52.204-23](#) – Kaspersky prohibition
- [FAR 52.204-25](#) – Certain telecom/video surveillance equipment or services
- [FAR 52.204-27](#) – ByteDance-covered applications
- [DFARS 252.204-7018](#) – Covered defense telecom equipment or services

- [FAR 52.225-13](#) – Restrictions on Certain Foreign Purchases.

10.2 Drug-Free Workplace

“The unlawful manufacture, distribution, dispensing, possession, or use of a controlled substance is prohibited in our workplace.” IA will evaluate violations case-by-case and impose corrective action as appropriate.

- All IA-controlled spaces—including customer sites and field locations—are drug-free zones.
- Some contracts may require certification or testing, and employees will be notified accordingly.

Applicable Clauses:

- [FAR 52.226-7](#) – Drug-Free Workplace (civilian agencies)
- [DFARS 252.226-7003](#) – Drug-Free Work Force (DoD)

10.3 Employee Rights & Whistleblower Protection

Employee rights

- IA must inform you of your rights to organize, bargain collectively, and engage in protected concerted activity under the National Labor Relations Act.
- IA cannot require employees or applicants to agree to mandatory arbitration for claims under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act or for sexual assault or harassment, as a condition of employment.
- IA is prohibited from requiring employees or subcontractors to sign internal confidentiality agreements that restrict lawful reporting of waste, fraud, or abuse to the government.

Whistleblower rights

- You may lawfully disclose evidence of gross waste, fraud, abuse, or other wrongdoing on a federal contract without fear of retaliation.

Applicable Clauses:

- [FAR 52.222-40](#) – Notification of Employee Rights under the NLRA
- [DFARS 252.203-7002](#) – Requirement to inform employees of DoD whistleblower rights
- [DFARS 252.222-7006](#) - Restrictions on the Use of Mandatory Arbitration Agreements.
- [FAR 52.203-19](#) - Prohibition on Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements.

10.4 Employment Eligibility – E-Verify

IA participates in E-Verify to confirm each employee's eligibility to work in the United States.

- Complete Form I-9 within three business days of hire and respond promptly to any E-Verify inquiries.
- The employees must be made aware of the following notices:
- Right-to-Work Notice (Appendix C)
- Notice of E-Verify Participation (Appendix D)

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.222-54](#)

10.5 Texting While Driving

Employees operating any motor vehicle on IA business are asked to not text, e-mail, or otherwise interact with a hand-held device.

- Use hands-free features or safely pull over before using your device.

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.226-8](#)

10.6 Gratuities

We're prohibited from offering or giving gratuities (e.g., gifts, favors) to government personnel to obtain or reward favorable treatment, and violations may result in contract termination or other penalties.

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.203-3](#)

10.7 Information Security & Acceptable IT Use

IA's Atomus environment is the only authorized system for processing Covered Defense Information (CDI). Keep Atomus current, control removable media, and use contract data only in authorized cloud services.

- Update Atomus after patch releases.
- Obtain approval before plugging in any external drive or thumb-drive.
- Use of cloud services need to be approved by IA leadership when dealing with CUI and/or ITAR data (we can reference [FedRAMP Marketplace](#) to check for FedRAMP Moderate for compliance with CUI data for example, but extra considerations must be taken before fully approved).
- "Overhead/commercial" development vs. CUI work: Check with IA leadership on your specific project's distinction on what constitutes "Overhead/commercial" development vs. CUI work. This will guide what cloud services (specific cloud LLM's, etc.) can be used on each portion of the project.
- When in doubt, don't paste it. Ask leadership for guidance.

Applicable Clauses:

- [FAR 52.204-21](#) – Basic safeguarding of contractor information systems
- [DFARS 252.204-7012](#) – Safeguarding CDI & cyber incident reporting
- [DFARS 252.204-7020](#) – NIST SP 800-171 DoD assessment requirements

10.8 Information Procedures

- We shall not release to anyone outside our organization any unclassified information pertaining to any part of this contract.
- We shall also not claim copyright, trademark, or intellectual property rights over any work created by U.S. Government employees in the course of their official duties. We're also limited in the use and disclosure of government-furnished information marked with restrictive legends to purposes directly related to the contract, and prohibited from unauthorized reproduction, release, or use outside the contract's scope.

- We're required to comply with all applicable U.S. export control laws and regulations when handling export-controlled items, including technical data or services, under a DoD contract.
- It's required to get verbal or written approval from the leadership team before posting materials publicly related to Interactive Aptitude LLC business. This is in order to stay compliant with cybersecurity requirements, to ensure there is no controlled information being publicly released.
- We cannot add IP restrictions to data that government employees have generated.

Applicable Clauses:

- DFARS [252.204-7000](#) - Disclosure of Information
- DFARS [252.204-7003](#) - Control of Government Personnel Work Product
- DFARS [252.227-7025](#) - Limitations on the Use or Disclosure of Government- Furnished Information Marked With Restrictive Legends
- DFARS [252.225-7048](#) - Export-Controlled Items

10.9 Materials

- We're prohibited from storing, treating, or disposing of toxic or hazardous materials on a DoD installation unless specifically authorized.
- We're prohibited from the use of hexavalent chromium in any deliverable or construction material under a Department of Defense contract unless an exception is authorized.
- We're required to use domestic end products and materials, giving preference to U.S.-made goods to support the Buy American Act and Balance of Payments Program, unless an exception applies. We're also requires contractors to give preference to certain domestically produced commodities—such as food, textiles, hand or measuring tools, and specialty metals—when performing DoD contracts.
- We're restricted with the acquisition of ball and roller bearings not wholly manufactured in the U.S. or qualifying countries, including both bearing and bearing components.
- If IA—or any subcontractor—moves contract supplies by ocean transport, we must provide advance written notice to the Government.
- Mandated that all materials delivered under the contract must be new, unless otherwise specified in the contract, and free from defects that would affect performance or durability.
- Prohibited from using, procuring, or operating unmanned aircraft systems (UAS) that are manufactured or assembled by entities covered under the American Security Drone Act, including certain foreign adversary countries.

Applicable Clauses:

- DFARS [252.223-7006](#) Prohibition On Storage, Treatment, and Disposal of Toxic or Hazardous Materials
- DFARS [252.223-7008](#) Prohibition of Hexavalent Chromium
- DFARS [252.225-7001](#) Buy American and Balance of Payments Program
- DFARS [252.225-7012](#) Preference for Certain Domestic Commodities.
- DFARS [252.225-7016](#) Restriction on Acquisition of Ball and Roller Bearings.
- [DFARS 252.247-7023](#) Transportation of Supplies by Sea
- FAR [52.211-5](#) Material Requirements
- FAR [52.240-1](#) Prohibition on Unmanned Aircraft Systems Manufactured or Assembled by American Security Drone Act-Covered Foreign Entities.

10.10 Telecom Representations

IA must formally represent to the Government whether it uses, or plans to use, any covered telecommunications equipment or services—both under FAR and DFARS. These representations are made during proposal submission and must be kept current.

- If you become aware that IA is using or considering any covered telecom product or service (see Section 1), immediately notify leadership so representations can be updated.
- These representation clauses work in tandem with the prohibitions in Section 1—Section 1 says “don’t use it,” and these clauses require IA to certify that we don’t.

Applicable Clauses:

- [FAR 52.204-26](#) – Covered Telecommunications Equipment or Services—Representation
- [DFARS 252.204-7016](#) – Covered Defense Telecommunications Equipment or Services—Representation

10.11 Personal Identity Verification (PIV)

Employees who require routine physical access to a federally controlled facility or routine access to a federally controlled information system must comply with Homeland Security Presidential Directive 12 (HSPD-12) personal identity verification requirements.

- Comply with all government background investigation and credentialing processes (e.g., CAC or PIV card issuance).
- Return all government-issued credentials when your assignment ends or when requested.
- Report lost or stolen credentials to leadership immediately.

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.204-09](#) – Personal Identity Verification of Contractor Personnel

10.12 Equal Opportunity

IA is an equal opportunity employer. We do not discriminate against any employee or applicant on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, disability, or veteran status.

- All hiring, promotion, compensation, and termination decisions must be based on job-related qualifications and performance.
- IA will post the required EEO notices and include the equal opportunity clause in applicable subcontracts.
- Report any concerns about discrimination to leadership.

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.222-26](#) – Equal Opportunity

10.13 Combating Trafficking in Persons

The U.S. Government has a zero-tolerance policy regarding trafficking in persons. IA and all employees are prohibited from engaging in any trafficking-related activities.

- You may not engage in severe forms of trafficking, procure commercial sex acts, or use forced labor in the performance of any contract.
- You may not destroy, conceal, or confiscate an employee's identity or immigration documents.
- Report any suspected trafficking activity to leadership immediately.

Applicable Clause: [FAR 52.222-56](#) – Certification Regarding Trafficking in Persons Compliance Plan

10.14 CMMC Compliance (Level 1)

IA must meet, at a minimum, Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) Level 1 requirements. Where an individual contract flows down higher CMMC requirements, IA will meet those higher requirements for that contract.

- Every employee plays a role: follow the IT and information security policies in Section 7, use only approved systems, lock your workstation, and report suspicious activity to leadership team.

Applicable Clause: [DFARS 252.204-7012 DEV 2024-O0013](#) – CMMC Assessment and Certification Requirements

10.15 Health & Safety on Air Force Installations

Employees working on or visiting Air Force installations must comply with all applicable installation safety, fire protection, and environmental requirements.

- Follow all posted safety rules, wear required personal protective equipment (PPE), and attend any mandatory safety briefings when working on an Air Force installation.
- Report any workplace injuries, unsafe conditions, or near-misses to your supervisor and the installation safety office and leadership team immediately.

Applicable Clause: DFARS 5352.223-9001 – Health and Safety on Government Installations

10.16 Export Controls — ITAR & EAR

IA handles technical data and defense articles that may be controlled under the International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR, 22 CFR Parts 120–130) and the Export Administration Regulations (EAR, 15 CFR Parts 730–799). Unauthorized export—including “deemed exports” (sharing controlled information with a foreign national inside the U.S.)—can result in severe criminal and civil penalties.

- Do not share ITAR-controlled technical data, software, or defense articles with any foreign person (including foreign-national coworkers) without prior authorization from leadership and a valid export license or exemption.
- Do not upload ITAR- or EAR-controlled data to any cloud service, LLM, or external system that has not been approved by IA leadership (see Section 7 for approved environments).
- Look for export-control markings (e.g., “ITAR Controlled,” “Export Controlled”) on documents and drawings. When in doubt, treat the information as controlled and ask leadership.
- Do not hand-carry controlled technical data across international borders without prior written approval.

- Violations of ITAR can carry criminal penalties of up to \$1 million and 20 years imprisonment per violation. EAR violations can result in fines up to \$300,000 per violation.

Applicable Regulations:

- International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120–130
- Export Administration Regulations (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730–799
- See also [DFARS 252.225-7048](#) – Export-Controlled Items (Section 8)

11 Compliance with Applicable Law and Severability

Compliance with Applicable Law. This handbook is intended to comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, regulations, executive orders, and binding contract clauses, including but not limited to the Fair Labor Standards Act, Title VII of the Civil Rights Act, the Americans with Disabilities Act, the Family and Medical Leave Act, the National Labor Relations Act, the Defense Trade Secrets Act, the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), and the Defense FAR Supplement (DFARS). Where any provision of this handbook conflicts with applicable federal, state, or local law, or with a binding clause in any IA contract, the law or contract clause controls and the conflicting provision is deemed modified to the minimum extent necessary to comply. Where state or local law provides greater rights or protections to an employee than this handbook, that law applies.

Multi-state employees. IA employs individuals in multiple states. Provisions of this handbook will be applied consistent with the law of the state in which the employee primarily works. State-specific addenda or notices, where required, supplement and (where in conflict) supersede the general provisions of this handbook for employees in that state.

Severability. If any provision of this handbook is held to be invalid, unlawful, or unenforceable by a court, agency, or arbitrator of competent jurisdiction, that provision will be enforced to the maximum extent permitted by law, and the remaining provisions will continue in full force and effect.

No contract; right to amend. This handbook is a statement of current policy only. It is not an employment contract, express or implied, and does not alter the at-will employment relationship. IA reserves the right to interpret, amend, suspend, or rescind any provision of this handbook at any time, with or without notice, except as prohibited by law.

Appendix A: Employee Handbook Acknowledgement and Receipt

I hereby acknowledge receipt of the employee handbook of **Interactive Aptitude LLC (IA)**. I understand and agree that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies in the handbook.

I understand that the handbook and all other written and oral materials provided to me are intended for informational purposes only. The handbook, company practices, and other communications do not create an employment contract or term. I understand that the policies and benefits, both in the handbook and those communicated to me in any other fashion, are subject to interpretation, review, removal, and change by management at any time without notice.

I further understand that I am an at-will employee and that neither this document nor any other communication shall bind the company to employ me now or hereafter and that my employment may be terminated by me or the company without reason at any time. I understand that no representative of the company has any authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period of time or to assure any other personnel action or to assure any benefits or terms or conditions of employment or make any agreement contrary to the foregoing.

I also understand and agree that this agreement may not be modified orally and that only the president of the company may make a commitment for employment. I also understand that if such an agreement is made, it must be in writing and signed by the president of the company.

Employee's Name in Print

Signature of Employee

Date Signed by Employee

TO BE PLACED IN EMPLOYEE'S PERSONNEL FILE

Appendix B: Right To Work Poster

Please [click here](#) to download a copy of the required poster.

Appendix C: Notice of E-Verify Participation

Please [click here](#) to download a copy of the required poster.